

Board of Sanitary Commissioners October 1st, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dt78EI9d4hk
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Board of Sanitary Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: October 1, 2025

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:03:17](#) The meeting of the Board of Sanitary Commissioners was called to order on October 1, 2025, by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:** All sanitary district commissioners were noted as present, with no excused absences.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** [00:03:17](#) The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** [00:04:01](#) The board considered the minutes from the September 17, 2025, meeting. A motion to approve was made and seconded, passing with four "Aye" votes and one abstention from Mr. Clark.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:04:23](#) Register of Claims

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board President / Financial Record
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed a register of claims totaling \$1,650,288.03. The president highlighted a \$284,000 refund issued to Ball State University due to an overpayment caused by incorrect water company billing figures (upon which district billing is based).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:05:18 District Administrator Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad, District Administrator
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *Engineering & Operations:* Engineering crews continue repairs across town, remaining on Hodson for a short period before moving to MLK in front of the Ball Statewh/Muncie Bindery Center, which may cause upcoming lane restrictions.
 - *Fleet Updates:* The sanitation department successfully acquired two used CNG (compressed natural gas) trash trucks from Moline, Illinois, complementing new trucks to help modernize the fleet.
 - *White River Cleanup:* Sanitation helped collect trash and participated in the White River cleanup event, which was reported as very successful.
 - *State Board of Accounts:* The district received its annual State Board of Accounts report with **no findings**.
 - *Leaf Season Transition:* Beginning a multi-week announcement campaign regarding the transition away from plastic bags for leaf disposal to enable composting. The district is purchasing paper bags to distribute initially to high-leaf neighborhoods and eventually open to the public, aiming to offset costs and reduce landfill fees (noting disposal costs exceed \$53 per ton for roughly 700 tons of leaves).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
- **00:09:50 Bureau of Water Quality Department Head Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chuck Jones, Director, and Laura Bolley, Bureau of Water Quality
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Chuck Jones reported that summer biological field collections with interns have concluded, and data analysis is underway (with a future presentation on the "health of the river" planned). Quotes for new lab equipment are currently being solicited.
 - Laura Bolley announced that the Bureau of Water Quality was awarded the **Indiana Governor's Award of Environmental Excellence in Land Use and Conservation** on September 17th.

- The update highlighted the bureau's freshwater mussel propagation program (started in 2021). Adult mussels filter 10-15 gallons of water daily, removing excess sediment, nitrogen, and phosphorus. The program released 123 mussels in 2023, plans to release 750 by the end of the year, and is overwintering 1,600 more. This filtration capacity removes significant pollutants and prevents downstream impacts. The program operates primarily on grants.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; board members offered congratulations and praise for the program's cost-effectiveness and state recognition.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No members of the public stepped forward to speak during the general public comment period (00:03:50).
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - 00:21:34 Board member Mr. Overton requested that Chuck Jones provide a follow-up analysis detailing potential cost savings and outside revenue opportunities associated with the proposed new lab equipment.
 - **Adjournment:** 00:22:41 With no further old or new business, a motion and second were made to adjourn the meeting. Approved by Voice Vote.
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